

6.2b

Linking words and paragraph structure

Worksheet

- D** Look at paragraphs 1–4 from a report about Kalia. The first sentence is missing each time.

Investment opportunities in Kalia

- 1 The Government is liberalizing the economy and many nationalized industries are being privatized. Inflation is finally under control and industrial output is growing.
- 2 Roads and telecommunications are being modernized and a new port is being built at the mouth of the Delta river.
- 3 One of Kalia's success stories has been the growth of software exports, and leading multinational suppliers like Hewlett-Packard and Acer have strong Kalian partners.
- 4 The reform process has slowed down in recent months as politicians fear that their policies are becoming unpopular, particularly among workers in the large state-owned industries. There are also doubts about Kalia's ability to generate enough electricity for its industrial sector.

Choose the best opening sentence for each paragraph from those in the box below (two are not used).

- | |
|--|
| <ol style="list-style-type: none">a However, there are still many problems ahead.b Opportunities for investing in Kalia have never been better.c High interest rates are not the only cause of the economic recession.d Rapid progress is being made in the area of infrastructure.e Reform of the financial sector will be crucial to Kalia's continuing development.f The government has recognized the importance of information technology. |
|--|

- The sentences in the box are called topic sentences. What is a 'topic sentence'?
- In general, when do you start a new paragraph?

- E** Write a few paragraphs for a report on *The Future of My Market*:

- First write some topic sentences, each one introducing and summarizing a new idea.
- Then expand each topic sentence into a full paragraph by adding another sentence or two.
- Remember to use linking words to help the reader to see how your argument is developing.

Example: *The Future of the Financial Services Market*

Topic sentences

- 1 Companies in the financial services sector all offer similar products.
- 2 In the future, the trend will be to produce solutions for individual customers rather than mass marketing.
- 3 More and more, financial products will be sold over the phone and the Internet.
- 4 The industry needs to make its products easier to understand for the ordinary person.

Topic sentences expanded into paragraphs

- 1 Companies in the financial services sector all offer similar products. There is very little difference between the pension plans and life insurance policies of the main companies. Some may have a better past performance than others, but this is no guide to the future. In fact the only real difference that the customer notices is the advertising.
- 2 However, this situation cannot last for much longer. In the future, the trend will be to produce solutions for ...

